Module title: Business Information Systems Project
SITS Module Code: 6BUIS007C
Credit level: 6
Length: Yearlong
UK credit value: 20
ECTS credit value: 10
College and School: Westminster International University in Tashkent
Module Leader: Shirin Primkulova
Host Course: BSc Business Information Systems
Progression and assessment board: BSc Business Information Systems
Pre-requisites: N/A
Co-requisites: N/A
Study abroad: N/A
Special features: N/A
Access restrictions: N/A
Are the module learning outcomes delivered, assessed, or supported through an arrangement with organisation(s) other than the University of Westminster: No
Summary of module content: The Project module requires students to carry out their own piece of independent research under the guidance of a supervisor. The research topic and prototype solution chosen must be appropriate within the Business Information Systems area. A detailed project guide is provided which contains comprehensive guidance to the project process.

Assessment Methods

Rank	Assessment type	Assessment name	Weighting
1	Project	BIS Project (report and viva)	100%

Synoptic assessment

N/A

Learning outcomes

By the end of the module the successful student will be able to:

- LO1 - Carry out a comprehensive literature review of issues related to a selected area of Business Information Systems and critically evaluate their findings.
- LO2 - Prepare a timetabled research plan and manage their time effectively so that they are able to follow this plan.
- LO3 - Articulate competency in aspects of: business needs analysis, business systems design, and implement/review some aspects of the system.
- LO4 - Critically evaluate the work undertaken and analysis of their findings in a suitable manner and complimenting appropriate conclusions.
- LO5 - Produce a well-structured and coherent report of an extended piece of work and product prototype and be able to defend these at a viva voce examination.
- LO6 - Justify the methods, processes and tools used in carrying out the project.
- LO7 - Demonstrate creative thinking in approaching novel problems.

Course outcomes the module contributes to:

BSc (Hons) in Business Information Systems:

CLO6.1 Evaluate the organisational and managerial implications of IS/IT considering factors of the business environment; (PPP, GA, KTS)

CLO6.2 Identify, analyse and specify user requirements to develop or to select an appropriate information system solution (desktop/web/mobile); (PPP, KTS, SDG9)

CLO6.3 Critically analyse the need for an information systems strategy in business and perform planning for development; (PPP, KTS, SDG17)

CLO6.4 Identify, apply and evaluate various information systems and information management techniques for business/science related tasks; (PPP, SDG17)

CLO6.5 Carry out a comprehensive literature review of issues related to a selected area of business information systems and critically evaluate the findings; (KTS, SDG9)

CLO6.6 Critically analyse current trends in technology and suggest the most appropriate resources/tools for given business problem; (KTS, SDG8, SDG9)

CLO6.7 Specify, design, develop and test complex information systems to address business problems with respect to privacy, usability, stability and maintainability. (PPP, SDG8, SDG9)

Embedding Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) into the Module

This module contributes to Sustainable Development Goals through focusing on promoting sustained, inclusive, and sustainable economic growth, full and productive employment, and decent work for all (SDG8), it is supported through the evaluation of business systems, the analysis of current trends in technology, and the application of tools to business problems. In addition, the module supports building resilient infrastructure, promoting inclusive and sustainable industrialization, and fostering innovation (SDG9). Furthermore, aiming to strengthen the means of implementation and revitalize the global partnership for sustainable development, the module promotes collaboration, strategic planning, and analysis in the context of information systems for businesses (SDG17).

Indicative syllabus content

- Project initiation – development of project plan, scope, defining objectives
- IT project management specifics
- Literature review and research essentials for information systems projects
- Systems development essentials, modelling requirements
- IT strategy and system/design architecture
- Industry and competitor analysis
- Interface design, usability, product quality and testing
- Written presentation of research and results analysis

Teaching and learning methods

The module rationale is to support students in developing into independent learners, applying the knowledge and skills gained throughout the studies, acquiring new knowledge, and addressing the challenges imposed by the project.

Students are allocated a supervisor who guides and directs them throughout the module.

Based on their interest, the students select a project topic. Students are also exposed to project topics proposed by academics, reflecting ongoing research conducted by the faculty team, which presents the opportunity for student/academic/industry collaborations. The student and the supervisor agree upon the project to ensure it complies with the Final Year Project requirements. Students work independently, and they form, execute, and adapt a project plan depending on developing circumstances in consultation with their supervisor.

Teaching and learning methods include independent learning, scheduled lectures and regular meetings with supervisors.

Lectures related to all aspects of the Final Year Project lifecycle are planned to provide required guidance and feedback to students. Students are expected to attend regular meetings with their supervisor to review progress and discuss various aspects of the project.

Activity type	**Category**	**Student learning and teaching hours***
Lecture	Scheduled	12
Seminar	Scheduled	
Tutorial	Scheduled	
Project supervisor	Scheduled	12
Demonstration	Scheduled	
Practical classes and workshops	Scheduled	
Supervised time in studio/workshop	Scheduled	
Fieldwork	Scheduled	
External visits	Scheduled	
Work based learning	Scheduled	
Scheduled online learning	Scheduled	
Other learning	Scheduled	
Total scheduled		24

Placement	Placement	
Independent study	Independent	176
Total student learning and teaching hours		200

*hours per activity type are indicative and subject to change.

Assessment rationale: why has this assessment been used for this module?

The assessment covers both the product delivered by the student at the end of the module, and the process by which this product was developed. The module is assessed by Practical Project, which will cover all learning outcomes (LO1 – LO7).

Formative submissions will include:

- Project Proposal - a project initiation document that enables students to outline the proposed project idea, discuss the research available on the topic, identify the knowledge gap, and propose the implementation plan and get the approval from the supervisor.
- Progress Report - a report and a presentation of the initial output from practical work (e.g. software prototype, code related to the development of research tools) that enable students to progress smoothly toward developing their Final Project deliverables. This submission also involves a presentation, where students will have to present verbally their written report and orally articulate the findings.

Summative component:

- BIS Project - the final output from the practical work. Students must submit a report (word count 5000 words) summarizing findings and presenting software artefacts produced. Students will also be required to demonstrate and defend their IT product during Viva Voce (30 min). Two members of staff, normally the project supervisor and a moderator, assess the student's performance. During the viva, the student is expected to demonstrate their practical output (i.e. software, working prototype, research outcomes) and to be tested on their understanding of relevant issues. Additionally, students are expected to demonstrate understanding of the wider context and propose further work. The Project covers LO1 - LO7.

Assessment criteria: what criteria will be used to assess my work on this module?

University Grade Descriptors are a benchmark point of reference, they are contextualised using specific subject specialist criteria specific to a particular assessment. [University Grade Descriptors]

Criteria for assessments are designed with reference to the University's generic criteria to measure students' ability to meet the learning outcomes of a module. Specifically, within this module you will find detailed grading descriptors as part of each assessment.

The final year project will examine to what extent the student has demonstrated the ability to:

- Carry out a comprehensive literature review of issues related to a selected area of Business Information Systems and critically evaluate their findings.

- Prepare a timetabled research plan and manage their time effectively so that they are able to follow this plan.
- Articulate competency in aspects of business needs analysis, business systems design, and implement/review of some aspects of the system.
- Assess the work conducted and analyse the findings in an appropriate way, supporting the conclusions with relevant evidence
- Produce a well-structured and coherent report of an extended piece of work and product prototype and be able to defend these at a viva voce examination.
- Justify the methods, processes and tools used in carrying out the project.
- Demonstrate creative thinking in approaching novel problems.

Sources

1. Dawson, Christian W. Projects in Computing and Information Systems: A Student's Guide. 3rd ed., Harlow, Pearson Education, 2015.
2. Goraga, Zemelak. Data Science Project Ideas for Thesis, Term Paper, and Portfolio. Self-published, Dec. 2023.
3. Ives Visagie. Mastering IT Project Management: The Ultimate Knowledgebase. Ives M Visagie, 2023.

Online resources

Online project management systems

- Jira - https://www.atlassian.com/software/jira/free
- Asana - https://asana.com/
- ClickUp - https://clickup.com/
- Trello - https://trello.com/
- YouTrack - https://www.jetbrains.com/youtrack/

Version control and code repositories

- GitHub - https://github.com/
- GitLab - https://gitlab.com/
- Bitbucket - https://bitbucket.org/
- YouTrack - https://www.jetbrains.com/youtrack/